

Large flying fox

Pteropus vampyrus

Unlike the smaller microbats, flying foxes do not echolocate to find their way around in the dark. Instead, they use their big eyes and sensitive noses to find fruit and flowers to eat in the rainforest. This diet gives them their other common name: fruit bat. Flying foxes spend

the day roosting upside down in large, noisy groups in trees. They can move around by using the thumbs on the edges of their wings to cling onto branches. At night they fly to feeding trees, which may be many miles away from their roost.

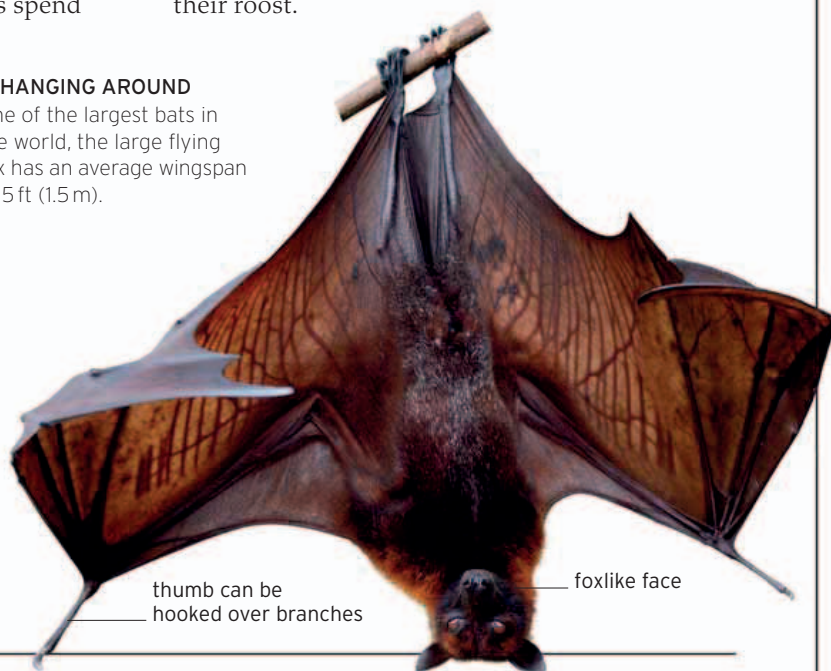
- ↔ 17 in (43cm)
- ⚖ 1–3 lb (0.5–1.4 kg)
- ⊗ Near threatened
- 🍷 Fruit, flowers, nectar
- 🏠 



SE. Asia

▷ HANGING AROUND

One of the largest bats in the world, the large flying fox has an average wingspan of 5 ft (1.5 m).



thumb can be hooked over branches

foxlike face

Western tarsier

Cephalopachus bancanus

Relative to its size, the western tarsier has the largest eyes of any mammal—each is slightly heavier than its brain. The eyes cannot move, but this nocturnal primate can turn its head to look backward for possible predators or prey. It also locates prey with its keen hearing, grabbing or leaping on its victim.

Leaping is the tarsier's main form of locomotion—it can jump across distances almost 40 times its body length. Mainly tree-dwelling, it has slender fingers and its toes have pads, nails, and sharp claws, for gripping branches.

Females have one offspring at a time. At first, the baby is carried by the mother, but it soon learns to cling to her fur.

- ↔ 5 in (13 cm)
- ⚖ 4–5 oz (113–141 g)
- ⊗ Vulnerable
- 🍷 Insects, bats, snakes, birds
- 🏠 



SE. Asia

▷ CLINGING ON

The agile western tarsier easily holds on to vertical trunks, using its long tail as a support.



- ↔ 61–76 cm (24–30 in)
- ⚖ 10–24 kg (22–53 lb)
- ⊗ Endangered
- 🍷 Leaves, unripe fruit, seeds
- 🏠 



SE. Asia

